

We shouldn't make AI art because it's causing extreme harm to the environment, not because it's not real art.

Posted by u/salaoosodjfffffn • 0 points • 23 comments

I don't think AI "art" is art, but I also don't care if other people do. What I do care about, and what more people should care about, is how much pollution and water waste is caused by AI generation. It's so ridiculously unnecessary.

Comments

u/Tyler_Zoro • 1 points • 2025-08-05 17:04 UTC

I've never heard a good argument for the environment impact theory. Most of it comes from bad anecdotes like Musk's xAI ruining Memphis' environment, almost always citing studies that are from before xAI was in Memphis.

u/TrapFestival • 1 points • 2025-08-05 16:03 UTC

"If every person on earth just recycled, stopped using plastic straws, and drove an electric car, 100 corporations would still produce 70% of total global emissions."

u/Mikhael_Love • 1 points • 2025-08-05 12:22 UTC

Activity/Device	Energy per Use	Daily Energy Usage	Annual Energy Usage	Equivalent AI Interactions	Power Draw
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AI Interaction (Single Prompt)	0.75 watt-hours	0.03 kWh (100 prompts)	7.2 kWh	1	0.2 watt-hours
Coffee Maker (Single Pot)	2.4 kWh	2.4 kWh	72 kWh	320 prompts	750-1200 watts
Single-Serve Coffee (One Cup)	75 watt-hours	150 watt-hours (2 cups)	7.5 kWh	100 prompts	900-1500 watts
5-Minute Hot Shower	1.6 kWh	1.6 kWh	N/A	640 prompts	N/A
Electric Car Ride (10km)	1.9 kWh	N/A	N/A	760 prompts	N/A
One Hour Video Streaming	0.8 kWh	N/A	N/A	320 prompts	N/A
One Minute Social Video	0.6 watt-hours	N/A	N/A	2 prompts	N/A

u/Mikhael_Love • 2 points • 2025-08-05 12:22 UTC

References

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 \[3\] – [<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>]
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u/Dersemonia • 1 points • 2025-08-05 10:59 UTC

You polluted more by creating this post than me generating an image on my pc.

If you really care about the environment you should look at yourself first and all the thing you do that pollute more than Ai. And trust me, there are a lot.

u/AA11097 • 5 points • 2025-08-05 10:20 UTC

Living in a house, fully powered by electricity as unethical. Do you know?

u/neloish • 4 points • 2025-08-05 10:10 UTC

Pencils require logging and mining, paint requires oil etc. Do you really think something that only uses electricity is worse than that?

u/Gustav_Sirvah • 3 points • 2025-08-05 10:06 UTC

Because paint, pens, pencils, paper all just happen to appear from nowhere. Production of paper is one of most enviromentally unfriendly industries...

u/ifandbut • 3 points • 2025-08-05 10:26 UTC

Not to mention all the ink for pens and books.

Rare earth mining for all our tech.

And eating a stake once a month

u/MushroomCharacter411 • 2 points • 2025-08-05 11:08 UTC

You're doing it wrong. The stake goes through the vampire's heart. Eating it is harmless to them.

u/TheHeadlessOne • 2 points • 2025-08-05 11:12 UTC

That's why Dracula's doctor told him to avoid red meat. Cos stake is bad for his heart

u/whoreatto • 2 points • 2025-08-05 09:57 UTC

Unnecessary pollution and clean water use happens everywhere, and AI art is responsible for a minuscule minority of that.

AI art is not necessary, and it makes people happy. It's a useful luxury. That doesn't imply that we should stop making it.

u/NeoTheRiot • 8 points • 2025-08-05 09:53 UTC

Your PC doesnt care if you run a local AI or play games on it. Why should one be worse than the other?

u/markmumi • 1 points • 2025-08-05 09:53 UTC

This is definitely a better argument, but it's still debatable. Some might say that a single picture created by an artist using a computer all day could consume more energy. I still haven't found any definitive proof that ends this argument once and for all both sides use numbers that favor their own position

u/Superseaslug • 14 points • 2025-08-05 09:53 UTC

It doesn't.

I can generate 500 images with the same power it takes to preheat my oven for a frozen pizza.

Streaming Netflix in 4k uses about 170w (roughly) which is about half the power draw of me generating images if I did it constantly. And most of that is from the TV just being on.

Using rough estimates (yeah I used GPT) it's about .85kwh per hour overall including server side.

In fact, AI is actually reducing carbon emissions in logistics by optimizing shipping routes and reducing waste.

So no. Your statement is not correct.

u/MushroomCharacter411 • 5 points • 2025-08-05 10:01 UTC

.85kwh per hour is just 850 kW.

u/Superseaslug • 3 points • 2025-08-05 10:05 UTC

Fair enough. 850W is a significant amount of power though. Far more than my home AI setup can draw

u/MushroomCharacter411 • 3 points • 2025-08-05 10:19 UTC

Far more than mine as well, although I have a 650W power supply because it's kinda hard to find a new, trustworthy power supply that `\*isn't\*` at least this "size". The GPU only has one 8-pin connector and I only have a 6-pin +12V line to it (that's all the power supply has) so it `\*should\*` only be able to draw 150W (75 over the PCIe slot, 75W over the +12V) although there's a good chance it's just ignoring or unaware of the fact that it's a 6-pin, meaning it may be pulling as much as 225W at full load. That's less than the TDP of the CPU I had before this rig! The CPU only has a TDP of 135W if I remember correctly. I think I'd have to shove data around all three drives (one NVMe, one SATA SSD, one spinning rust) and run a burn-in test AND a GPU torture test to ever exceed 400W.

u/Superseaslug • 1 points • 2025-08-05 10:59 UTC

The absolute max my GPU has drawn is 490W. And it's a 3090. Not sure about full system load though.

u/ArtisticLayer1972 • 6 points • 2025-08-05 09:52 UTC

Extreme? Bro you gona hate netflix

u/Dramatic-Shift6248 • 8 points • 2025-08-05 09:50 UTC

Well make us care, tell us, how much pollution is created and how much water is used to make an image? Is it more than watching an episode of a series on Netflix, or is that immoral too?

Pretty much any form of entertainment causes more pollution and uses more water.

u/4Shroeder • 20 points • 2025-08-05 09:50 UTC

Pound for pound you and me as consumers waste more by playing video games or leaving lights on when we go to bed.

Server farms exist both with and without AI.

You can run AI on a personal home computer. Your concerns aren't about AI, they're about industry bloat and resource hogging.

AI even unique in this endeavor. We should probably stop making plastic disposable silverware too, focusing on renewables like wood and metal. ****The difference is there isn't a hot trend to tell about wooden spoons.****

u/TheHeadlessOne • 5 points • 2025-08-05 09:45 UTC

How does the environmental impact of AI usage compare to alternative web based activities? Or just computer based activities?